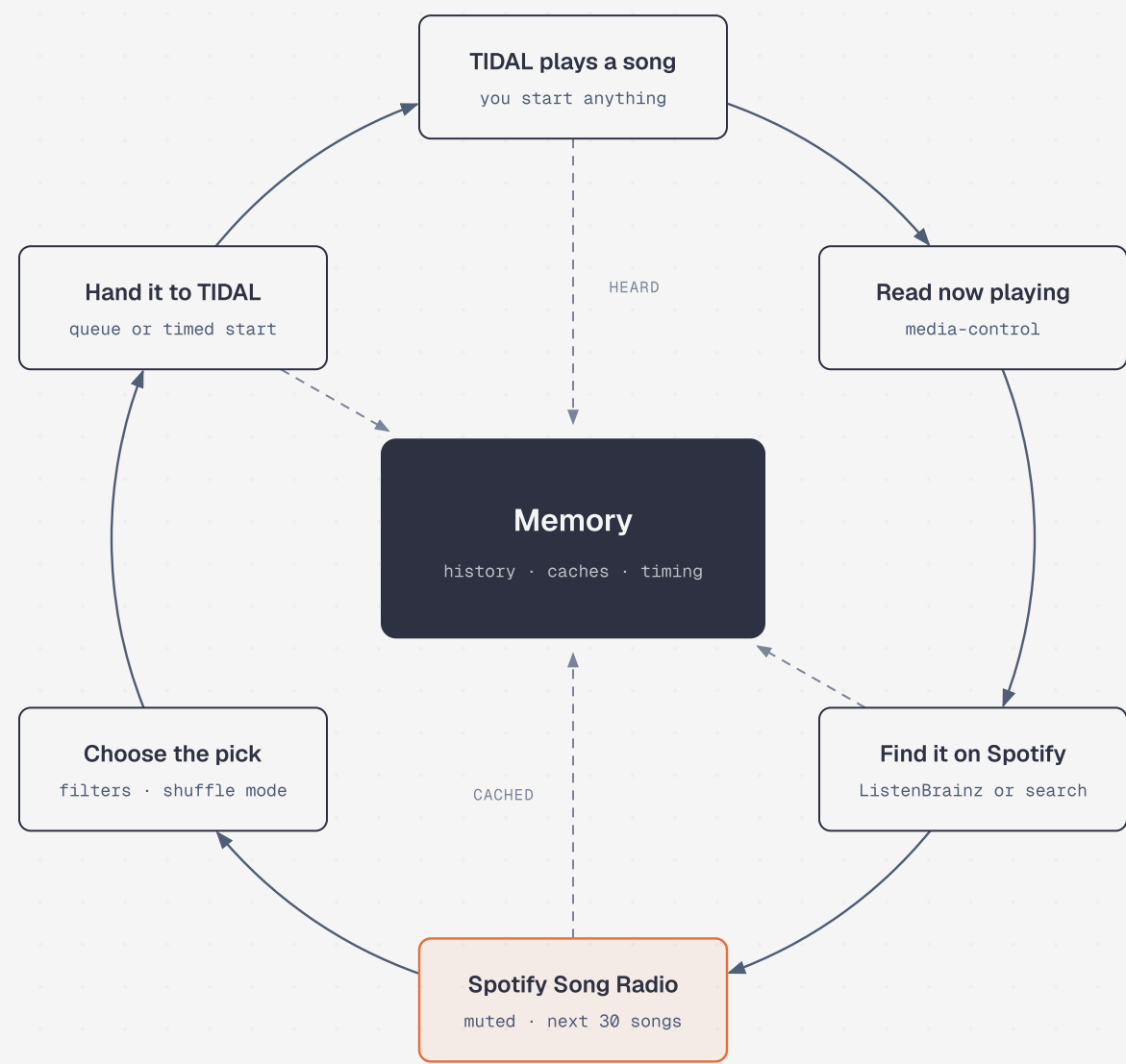


One song leads to the next

Every song TIDAL plays becomes the seed for the next pick. The pick plays, becomes the new seed, and the loop goes round again. Change songs yourself at any point and it follows you.



LEGEND



Where the next songs come from



Step



Order of steps (clockwise)



Saved for later passes



Shared memory

THE ENGINE

● Spotify Song Radio

Tidal Shuffle starts the song's radio in your Spotify app with the volume muted, skips through it to read the next 30 songs, then puts Spotify back as it was. No Premium or API key needed. Earlier songs on the radio score higher (1.0 down to 0.5).

FALLBACKS

● If Spotify can't help

- Last.fm similar tracks
- Deezer related songs
- TIDAL's own track radio

Tried in that order, only until one gives at least 3 songs.

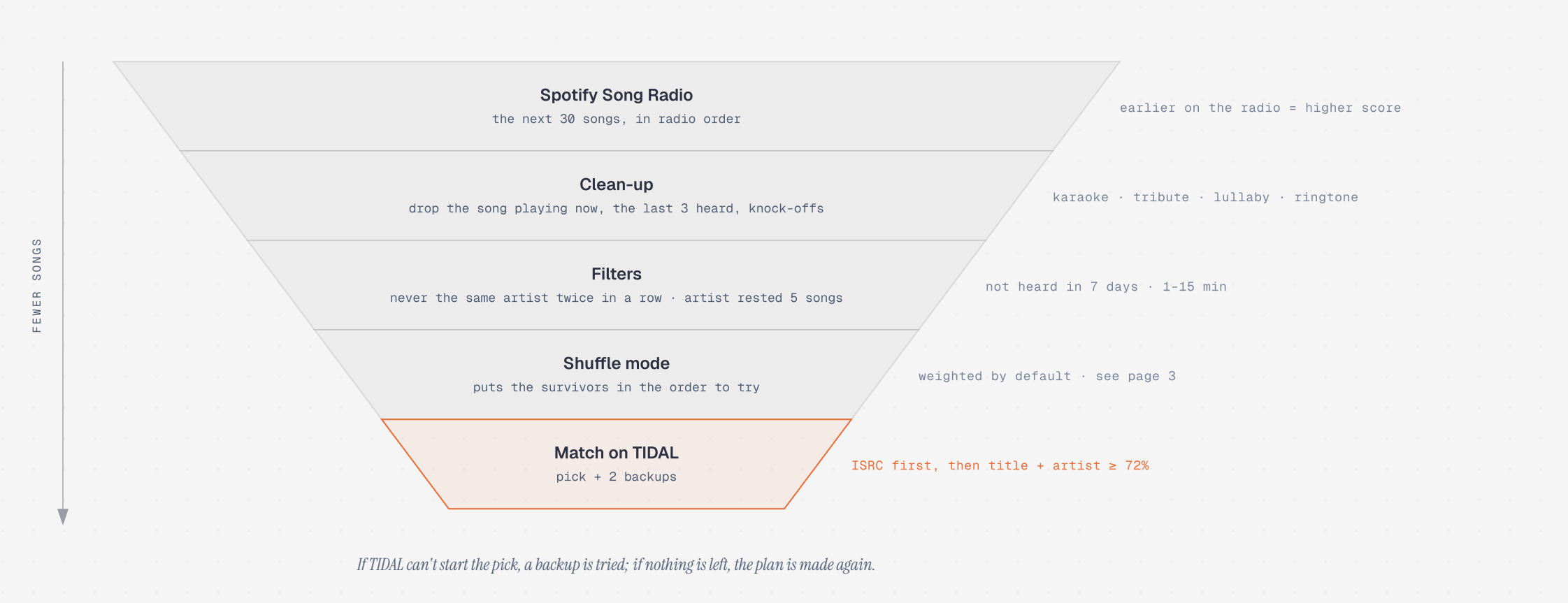
MEMORY

● What it remembers

- Every song heard, picked or not: no repeats for 7 days or 200 plays
- Spotify ids and radios, so a song is looked up once
- How long TIDAL takes to start a song

From 30 radio songs to one pick

The Spotify radio for the song now playing gives about 30 candidates. Four steps narrow them down to the song that plays next, plus two backups in case TIDAL can't start it.



LEGEND

Where a pick is confirmed

Narrowing step

Widths show the order of steps, not exact counts; how many songs survive depends on the song.

FILTERS

● When the filters leave nothing

They are relaxed one at a time, never all at once:

- first the 5-song artist rest is dropped
- then recent repeats are allowed
- never the artist playing now: if only that artist is left, the next source is asked

MATCHING

● Finding it on TIDAL

Each song is looked up on TIDAL by its ISRC code when known, otherwise by title and artist. A result must agree on both (at least 72%) and is checked again against your history, so a "Remastered" copy of a song you just heard is skipped too.

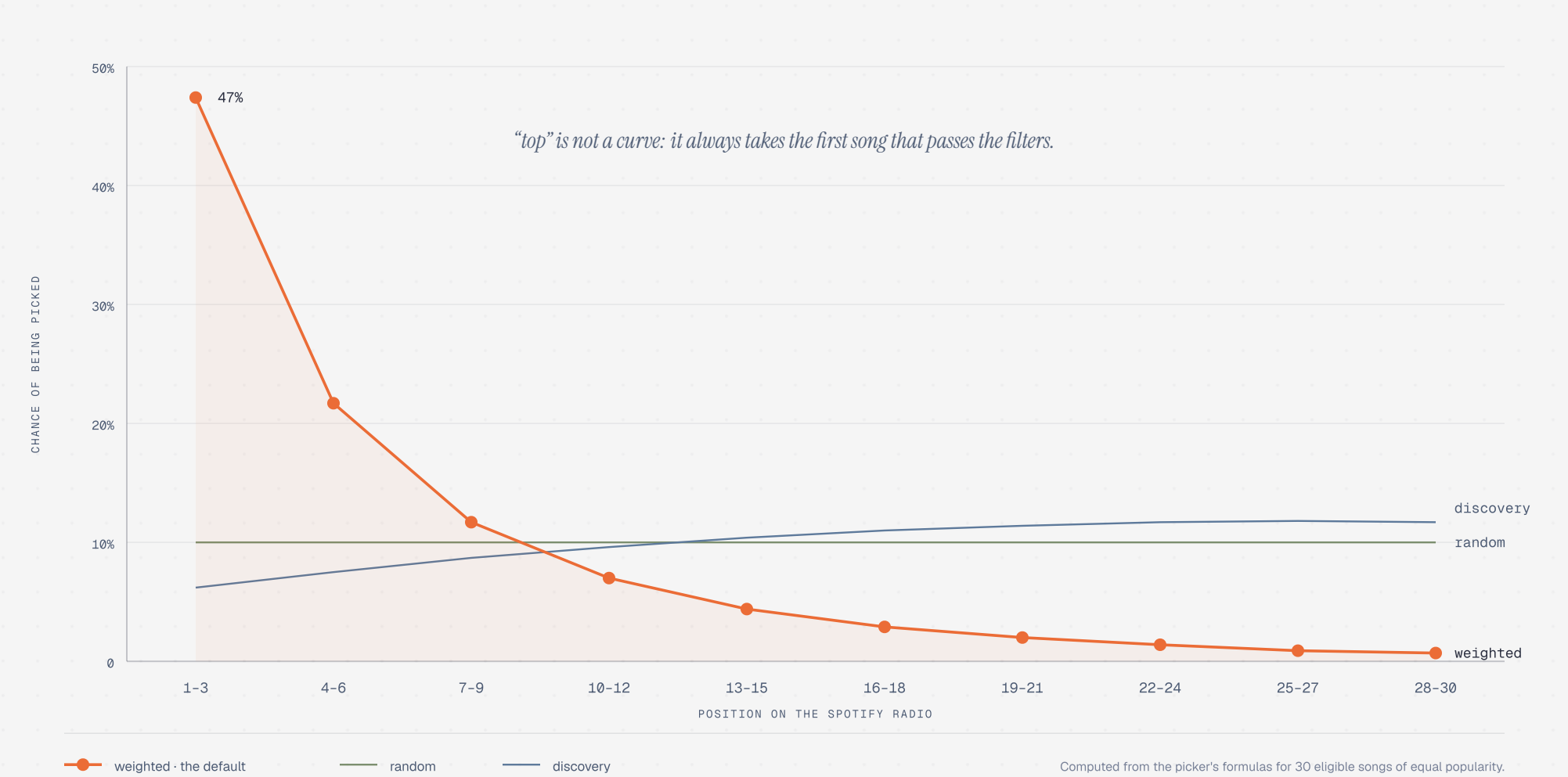
SETTINGS

● You can change

- `artist_cooldown`: songs before an artist returns (5)
- `avoid_repeats_days`: days before a song returns (7)
- `min_duration` / `max_duration`: 60 s / 15 min
- `allow_explicit`, `allow_seed_artist`

Where in the radio the pick comes from

The shuffle mode decides which of the surviving radio songs is tried first. Each line is the chance that the pick comes from that stretch of the Spotify radio.



DEFAULT

weighted

A random draw where each song's chance is its relevance squared, and relevance falls the further down the radio it is. The first three radio songs win 47% of the time and the first fifteen 92%, yet any of them can come up. Close to the song playing, but not predictable.

MODES

The other three

- **top**: always the closest match; most predictable
- **random**: every song that passes the filters is equally likely
- **discovery**: favours deeper and less popular songs (popularity is read from Spotify)

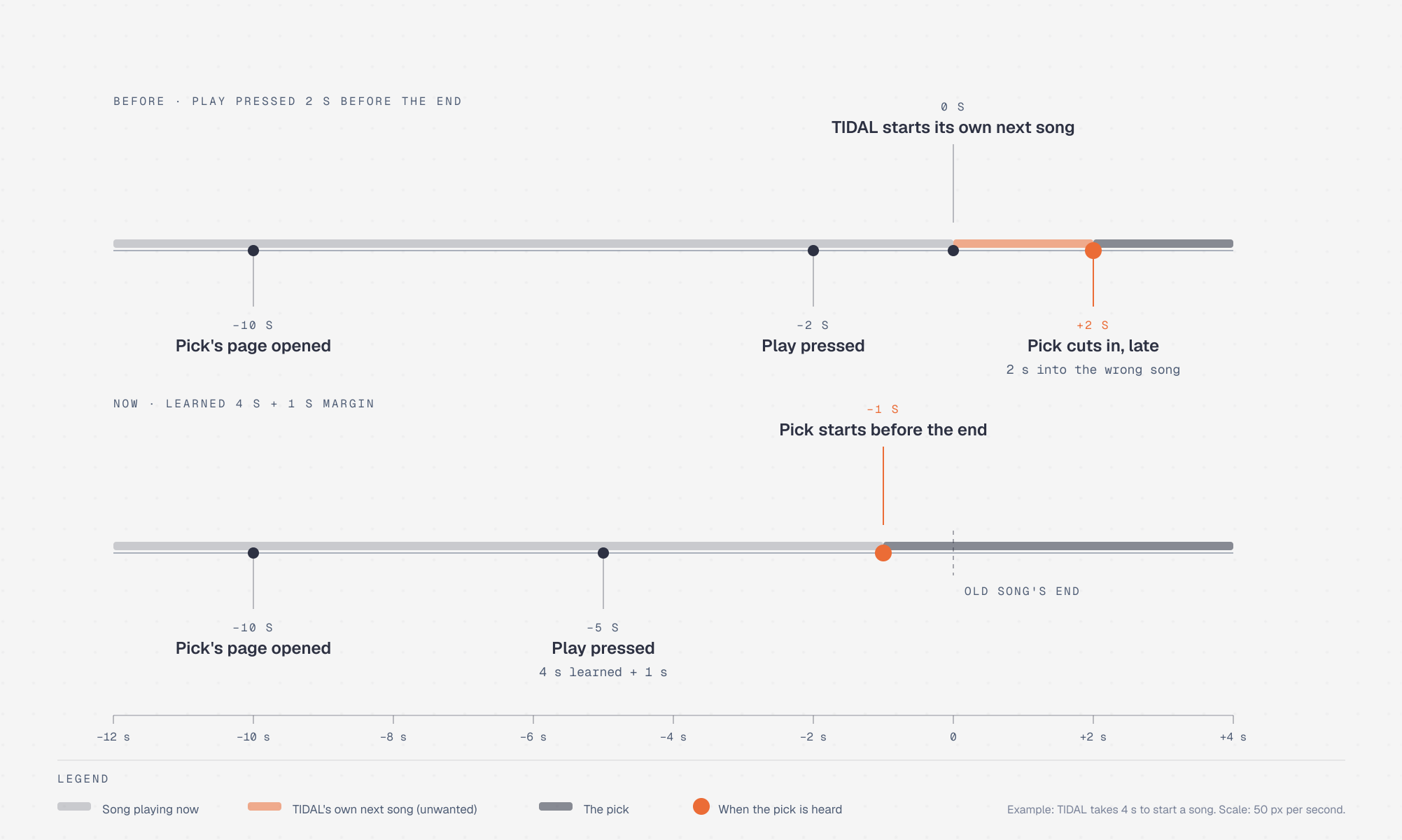
PRESETS

Choosing one

- `tidal-shuffle run --strategy top`
- `--preset discovery`: deeper cuts, 8-song artist rest
- `--preset familiar`: closest songs, same artist allowed
- `--preset wander`: random walk

When the next song starts

TIDAL needs a moment to start a song. Pressing play 2 s before the end was too late on your Mac: TIDAL's own next song began first, then the pick cut in. Now the delay is measured and play is pressed that much earlier.



BEST CASE

- Gapless, through TIDAL's queue

When TIDAL's own play queue can be read, the pick is put right after the current song. It only counts once the queue shows it as next, and it is checked again 10 s before the end. TIDAL then moves to it by itself: nothing cut, no gap.

OTHERWISE

- Timed start, learned

The pick's page opens 10 s before the end, and play is pressed early enough for TIDAL's start-up delay. That delay is measured on every hand-off from where macOS says the new song is. A longer delay is adopted at once, a shorter one gradually.

SETTINGS

- You can change
 - handoff_seconds: never later than this (3 s)
 - handoff_margin: extra on top of the delay (1 s)
 - adaptive_handoff: false to turn learning off
 - the delay is kept in timing.json